

Zaid Ahmad

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Education

B.Sc. Computer Science, AI and Machine Learning Stream | *Carleton University* Ottawa, ON · Sept 2024 – May 2028
Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, C/C++, Linear Algebra, Discrete Structures II, Web Applications

Technical Skills

Languages: C++, C, Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript

Frameworks & Libraries: React (Next.js), React Flow, Node.js, Express, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion

Tools & Platforms: Git/GitHub, GitHub Actions API, Firebase, MongoDB, Supabase, Linux, Netlify, Render, POSIX Threads

Experience

Logistics Coordinator | *cuHacking* Ottawa, ON · Sept 2025 – Present

- Reduced day-of coordination failures across a 200+ participant hackathon by authoring pre-event checklists and run-of-show documents that standardized setup for scheduling, rooms, and equipment.
- Eliminated resource shortfalls across 10+ teams on event day by tracking buffer stock and flagging inventory gaps during pre-event audits before they became blockers.

Hackathon Developer | *cuHacking 2025* Carleton University, ON · Mar 2025

- Placed 2nd out of 40+ teams in 24 hours by building ShelterMatch Ottawa – a full-stack shelter-matching platform covering 15 Ottawa shelters with real data, swipe-based UX, and JWT auth.
- Maintained zero downtime during judging by deploying a Node.js/Express backend across Netlify and Render with pre-configured environment parity between staging and production.

Projects

BuildAtlas – CI/CD Pipeline Visualizer | github.com/buildAtlasOrg

Next.js · TypeScript · React Flow · Node.js · GitHub Actions API · Tailwind CSS

- Removed the need to manually parse workflow JSON by building a Node.js service that transforms raw GitHub Actions runs into typed React Flow schemas with per-step status, duration, and dependency edges.
- Improved debuggability for multi-job pipelines by rendering failure paths and job boundaries as a navigable graph rather than a flat log.

ShelterMatch Ottawa | github.com/zaidahmad16/cuHacking-2025-Project

Next.js · React · Node.js · Express · Framer Motion · Tailwind CSS

- Reduced shelter search friction for Ottawa residents by building a swipe-based matching platform across 15 shelters with server-side filtering on gender, services, and accessibility; deployed live at sheltermatchottawa.shop.

SuburbanStreetBrawlUnity | github.com/vinit-rao/BlunderUnity

C# · Unity · Game Development

- Improved player movement feel and collision reliability across a 2D platformer by implementing physics-based character controllers and iterating on level geometry in Unity with a collaborator.

mac80211 HT Downgrade Fix | github.com/zaidahmad16/mac80211-ht-downgrade-fix

C · Linux Kernel · Wireless Networking

- Restored full HT mode throughput on an Intel AX200 card by diagnosing a beacon frame incompatibility with Rogers XB10 routers and patching the Linux mac80211 wireless stack driver.

Multithreaded C Simulation | github.com/zaidahmad16/COMP2401-Final-Project

C · POSIX Threads · Semaphores

- Achieved stable execution across 1,000+ simulated ticks with no deadlocks or memory leaks by implementing a concurrent agent simulation using POSIX threads, semaphore synchronization, and manual memory management.